

Now we'll write a separate program that uses `json.loads()` to read the list back into memory:

```
number
_reader.py  from pathlib import Path
            import json

            ❶ path = Path('numbers.json')
            ❷ contents = path.read_text()
            ❸ numbers = json.loads(contents)

            print(numbers)
```

We make sure to read from the same file we wrote to ❶. Since the data file is just a text file with specific formatting, we can read it with the `read_text()` method ❷. We then pass the contents of the file to `json.loads()` ❸. This function takes in a JSON-formatted string and returns a Python object (in this case, a list), which we assign to `numbers`. Finally, we print the recovered list of numbers and see that it's the same list created in *number_writer.py*:

```
[2, 3, 5, 7, 11, 13]
```

This is a simple way to share data between two programs.

Saving and Reading User-Generated Data

Saving data with `json` is useful when you're working with user-generated data, because if you don't store your user's information somehow, you'll lose it when the program stops running. Let's look at an example where we prompt the user for their name the first time they run a program and then remember their name when they run the program again.

Let's start by storing the user's name:

```
remember
_me.py  from pathlib import Path
        import json

        ❶ username = input("What is your name? ")

        ❷ path = Path('username.json')
          contents = json.dumps(username)
          path.write_text(contents)

        ❸ print(f"We'll remember you when you come back, {username}!")
```

We first prompt for a username to store ❶. Next, we write the data we just collected to a file called *username.json* ❷. Then we print a message informing the user that we've stored their information ❸:

```
What is your name? Eric
We'll remember you when you come back, Eric!
```
